

Scenario 9-10: 'FTP is not working'

You'll get this message for two problem sets. This problem descriptor means that you need to check for FTP configuration, but before you nose dive to your FTP configuration file, make sure your network, iptables and SELinux is working properly. Trouble-Maker doesn't deal with SELinux, so you can eliminate this possibility and set SELinux off by firing the `setenforce 0` command. Check the IP address, the network service status and IPTables configuration. If all is well, then check for the TCP wrappers files `/etc/hosts.allow` and `/etc/hosts.deny`. If you find `all:all` in `/etc/hosts.deny` file, then that's the problem as it's denying every connection to your system. Delete this line and now try to run the `ftp` command. It should work fine. Now if you are able to run `ftp` from this system but face issues in running the same command from another system, check `/etc/hosts.allow` file. You'll find the `all:local` line written over here, which is what has caused the connection error from the remote system. Delete it or make it `all:all` and the problem is solved.

Scenario 11: 'SSH not working'

First, try to `ssh` from the same machine; you won't be able to do it. It's always good to check network related issues from the same machine first and then go for a remote system. Like in the previous case, don't jump to SSH configuration hastily. Instead, follow the same procedure as we did before. This time you'll see a REJECT rule in iptables. You can verify it by stopping the iptables service and then try to `ssh`. This time you'll be able to do

so. Now that we've found the cause of the problem, all you need to do is to drop this rule, and everything will be fine after that.

Scenario 12: 'Enabling /etc/fstab swaps:FAILED'

If you got this error message after rebooting, then your `fstab` file has got some problems. Log in to single user mode and check just what went wrong with this file. In our case, this file has been deleted and you'll have to re-create it. You can take help from <http://www.linuxfromscratch.org/lfs/view/development/chapter08/fstab.html> to check for the `fstab` entries and get the task completed.

So far, we've examined 12 out of the 15 test cases, which is exactly 80 per cent of the given problem set. This reminds me of the Pareto Principle, according to which 80 per cent of the effects come from 20 per cent of the causes. What I am going to do right now is to leave the remaining 20 per cent (or three problems) for you. Now it's time for you to raise the bar and address these problems. Believe me—80 per cent of your learning is going to occur in the process of solving these problems on your own. So the stage is all set and now it's up to you to demonstrate your analysis and problem-solving abilities along with some serious Linux skills. **END** 

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